

The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra: The Chapter on the Maṇḍala of the Wind of the Great Cloud, the Heart-Essence of All Nāgas

Ārya-Mahāmegha-vāyu-maṇḍala-parivarta-sarvanāgahr̥daya-nāma-mahāyānasūtra · Toh
234 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་སྤྱི་ཆེ་པ་རྒྱ་གཞི་གཟུངས་པ་ལྟེ་གཟུངས་ཅད་གཟུངས་པ་ཞེས་བཀའ་བྱ་བ་ཐེག་པ་ཆེ་པའོ་མཛད་

Toh 234 in the Kangyur is a Mahāyāna sūtra known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-Mahāmegha-vāyu-maṇḍala-parivarta-sarvanāgaḥṛdaya and in Tibetan as Phags pa sprin chen po rlung gi dkyil 'khor gyi le'u klu thams cad kyi snying po, rendered in English as "The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra: The Chapter on the Maṇḍala of the Wind of the Great Cloud, the Heart-Essence of All Nāgas." The text belongs to the sūtra division of the Kangyur and centers on the world of the nāgas, serpentine beings associated with rain, water, and the natural elements, presenting the Buddha teaching in a jeweled ocean palace before a vast assembly of nāga kings possessed of great miraculous power. It is concerned with esoteric heart-essences or dhāraṇīs connected to nāgas and the wind-maṇḍala of the great cloud, themes that link it to both the sūtra and dhāraṇī literature of the Mahāyāna tradition. The text thus sits at the intersection of narrative sūtra and ritual-protective literature, reflecting a widespread Indian and Tibetan interest in harnessing the power of nāgas for rain, fertility, and spiritual protection.

In the language of India: Ārya-Mahāmegha-vāyu-maṇḍala-parivarta-sarvanāga
hrdaya-nāma-mahāyānasūtra.

In the language of Tibet: The noble Great Vehicle sūtra entitled "The Chapter on the Maṇḍala of the Wind of the Great Cloud, the Heart-Essence of All Nāgas."

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time, the Blessed One was dwelling in a great ocean, in a palace of stacked jewels with a pinnacle of precious gems, together with an immense assembly of nāgas complete in a full thousand, every one of them possessed of great miraculous power and attended by vast nāga retinues. They were none other than these: the nāga king Joyful, the nāga king Closely Joyful, the nāga king Truly Stirring, the nāga king Garland of Lightning, the nāga king Brilliant, the nāga king Greatly Brilliant, the nāga king Cast and Caught, the nāga king Conch, the nāga king Cardamom-Leafed, the nāga king

Good Boundaries, the nāga king Moving by Strength, the nāga king Producing Lightning, the nāga king Luminous with a Topknot, the nāga king Great Cloud Transformer, the nāga king Great Cloud Expander, the nāga king Dragon's Roar, the nāga king Rain-Producer, the nāga king Thousand Meteors, the nāga king Unseasonable Roarer, the nāga king Dragon's Voice, the nāga king Sending Forth Lightning, the nāga king Holding the Earth, the nāga king Without Grass, the nāga king Good Sight, the nāga king Luminous, the nāga king Great Dragon's Roar, the nāga king Shimmering Great Light, the nāga king Glorious Splendor, the nāga king Boundless, the nāga king Hollow Tube, the nāga king Holding Glory, the nāga king Drum Sound, the nāga king Voice of the Resounding Drum, the nāga king Plain, the nāga king Guide, the nāga king Glorious Throat, the nāga king Glorious and Good, the nāga king Great Hissing Sound, the nāga king Tinkling Sound, the nāga king Utterly Vanquishing, the nāga king Rain-Producer, the nāga king Great Wind Transformer, the nāga king Sending Forth Wind, the nāga king Calm, the nāga king Glorious, the nāga king Fine Lower Coils, the nāga king Auspicious, the nāga king Cloud Expander, the nāga king Cloud-Delighter, the nāga king of the Cloud-Covering Lineage, the nāga king Good Coverer, the nāga king Playful, the nāga king Son of Norgyas, the nāga king Anāvatapta, the nāga king Good Light, the nāga king Joyful to Behold, the nāga king Joyfully Purposeful, the nāga king Well-Covered by the Maṇḍala of Clouds, the nāga king Irresistible, the nāga king Drawing Water from Clouds, the nāga king Joyful to See, the nāga king Wind-Arising, the nāga king Churning the Wind, the nāga king Jewel on the Crest — together with those great nāga kings and yet another thousand great nāga kings who had gathered there as well.

All of them, through their great nāga miraculous power and their great nāga magical display, thundered in the sky in waves of sound, released a mighty rain of drops, and came into the presence of the Blessed One to make requests and to hear the Dharma.

Hey, great nāgas and nāgas, come here! Mulu mulu, cata cata, paṭa paṭa, maṭa maṭa, hā hā!

Burst forth lightning and release a mighty continuous stream of rain — let rain pour down! Hey, hey, great nāgas, call to mind the truth of the Buddha, the truth of the Dharma, the truth of the Saṅgha! Hey, great nāgas, come here, come here! Come forth, come forth! Let rain pour abundantly down upon Jambudvīpa! Guḍu guḍu, muḍu muḍu, hi hi hi hi, cuḍa cuḍa! Mahānāga hṛdaya, sarvanāgānā, ākaḍḍhya, sañcodaya, śīghrānādra svāhā!

Great clouds adorned with magnificent magical displays — their borders of golden cloth beautified with garlands of jewels of every color, with strands of pearl ornaments hanging down in cascades — clouds great as the ocean, and palatial halls made beautiful with divine jewels with flowers hanging in profusion, great ocean clouds consecrated to cover the entire vault of the sky, with clouds of jewels hanging down and many lengths of divine cloth and garlands of pearl ornaments — great ocean clouds, and clouds consecrated by the blessings of the profound and varied miraculous emanations of the buddhas, resounding with sound — great ocean clouds displaying in manifold and inconceivable variety the ornamental array of the Tathāgata's qualities — great ocean clouds with their vast array of jewels, consecrated to cover the entire vault of the sky completely — great ocean clouds that sound forth the thunderous roar of magnificent miraculous great clouds — great ocean clouds that ring out with the sweet sound of divine bells hung with garlands of varied jewels — great ocean clouds in which all manner of birds call out while raining down a great shower of flowers — great ocean clouds roaring with a vast sound, with divine jewels hanging in cascades, with varied strands of pearl hanging in profusion — great ocean clouds whose peaks, blazing with great radiance adorned with golden thread, cover the sky in every direction — great ocean clouds skilled in covering all of the sky with a maṇḍala of light from garlands of varied jewels — let the great ocean clouds, filled with the great oceanic sound bearing radiance, visibly cover the sky completely!

Let all nāgas and nāga kings come here! Thunder on the surface of this earth! Let rain pour down! Let rain pour abundantly! Let rain pour everywhere abundantly! Diri rir, cry out! Let great lightning blaze forth with radiance! Gather and assemble fully — with banners raised, pointing upward, standing here assembled — let those who emit the great and pleasing voice of the nāgas and who resound in great song let rain pour abundantly upon Jambudvīpa! Ghaḍa ghaḍa ghiḍi ghiḍi, huḍu huḍu, guḍu guḍu, gaḍa gaḍa, giḍi giḍi, maṭa maṭa, caṭa caṭa, paṭa paṭa! Hey, hey, nāgas and great nāgas, come here, come here! Come forth, come forth! Nghu nghu nghu nghu, hā hā hā hā, hī hī, hū hū, hūṃ hūṃ! Thunder with a great peal of thunder, send forth a mighty wind — by the truth of the Buddha, let rain pour abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa! Svāhā!

Hey, hey, nāgas and nāga kings, rouse all nāgas fully — let rain pour upon Jambudvīpa! Ghuḍu ghuḍu, phaḍa phaḍa, hā hā, he he! Great nāgas, assemble! Let rain pour abundantly upon the surface of the earth! Guru ghuru,

kiri kiri, ciri ciri, miri miri, diri diri, kili kili! Fill all fields completely! Let all grains, trees, grasses, creeping plants, and medicines grow abundantly! Come here with a mind of loving-kindness! By the truth of the Buddha —

by the truth of the Dharma, by the truth of the Saṅgha, by the truth of Vajrapāṇi, and by the truth of all nāgas — O great nāgas, come here, come here! The nāga king Dongbu is fully summoned. By the truth of the Buddha, let rain pour abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa! Svāhā!

The nāga king Splendid Majesty is fully summoned. By the truth of the Dharma, let rain pour abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa! Svāhā!

The nāga king Boundless is fully summoned. By the truth of the Saṅgha, let rain pour abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa! Svāhā!

The nāga king Son of Wealthy Expansion is fully summoned. By the truth of Vajrapāṇi, let rain pour abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa! Svāhā!

The nāga king The Steadfast is fully summoned. By the truth of Brahmā, let rain pour abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa! Svāhā!

The nāga king Glorious Throat is fully summoned. By the truth of Indra, let rain pour abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa! Svāhā!

The nāga king Son of the Earth-Guardian is fully summoned. By the truth of Viṣṇu, let rain pour abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa! Svāhā!

The nāga king Garlanded is fully summoned. By the truth of the Wrathful One, let rain pour abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa! Svāhā!

The nāga king the Lustrous is fully summoned. By the truth of the sages (ṛṣis), let rain pour abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa! Svāhā!

The nāga king the Terrifier is fully summoned. By the truth of the gods, let rain pour abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa! Svāhā!

The nāga king the Great Lustrous is fully summoned. By the truth of all nāgas, let rain pour abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa! Svāhā!

The nāga king the Utterly Vanquishing is fully summoned. By the truth of the yakṣas, let rain pour abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa! Svāhā!

All nāga kings are fully summoned. By the truth of the rākṣasas, let rain pour abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa! Svāhā!

By the truth of all the highest and highest nāgas, let rain pour abundantly — let rain pour! Come here without delay, come here, come here! Hey, hey, O

great nāgas, the very heart-essence of all nāgas is fully summoned! Lead them here from every direction! Sara sara, hā hā nhuma dhuma, hā hā hā hā, hi hi hi hi, e hyehi, tha tha tha, ca ca ca rata! Fill all fields completely! Let rain fall upon all crops! Release the great wind! Dhuma dhuma, ghūñ ghūñ, būm būma, ṭa ṭa ṭa ṭa! Nipāraṇi, stambhani, mohani, jāṃgūli, pukkasi, brāhāne, mātaṅgi, jaye vijaye! Hā hā svāhā!

The Tathāgata Essence of the Great Cloud of Splendid Majesty, the Tathāgata Great Cloud Utterly Vanquishing, the Tathāgata Cloud-Arisen, the Tathāgata Essence of the Great Cloud, the Tathāgata Great Cloud All-Covering, the Tathāgata Great Thunder Roaring, the Tathāgata Great Cloud Expanding, the Tathāgata King of the Sound of the Great Thunder Resounding, the Tathāgata Great Cloud Terrifying, the Tathāgata Great Cloud Protecting, the Tathāgata Great Cloud Drum-Sound, the Tathāgata Great Thunder Sound, the Tathāgata Great Cloud of Splendid Majesty, the Tathāgata Great Cloud Melodious Voice, the Tathāgata Great Cloud King of Stars, the Tathāgata Great Cloud King of Turmoil, the Tathāgata Great Cloud King Most Steadfast, the Tathāgata Great Cloud Maker of Steadfast Joy, the Tathāgata Great Cloud Rumbling Sound, the Tathāgata Great Cloud Terror of Terrors,

the Tathāgata Great Cloud Letting Fall the Thunderbolt, the Tathāgata Great Cloud King of Magical Displays, the Tathāgata Great Cloud of Auspicious Purpose — by the blessing of all buddhas and by the blessing of all bodhisattvas, the Tathāgata Great Cloud, the Great Cloud, is fully entreated in the essence of all. By the truth of all nāgas, the essence of all nāgas is fully entreated. By the scriptural command of the Three Jewels, come swiftly! Ho, ho — nāgas and great nāgas, come here, come here! Hulu hulu, suru suru, dhapa dhapa, ghara ghara, bhuru bhuru. Without delay, by the truth of the Buddha, come here! By the truth of the Dharma, come here! By the truth of the Saṅgha, come here! By the truth of all nāgas and the highest, most supreme great nāgas, let rain fall upon Jambudvīpa!

Dancing with the cry of "alala," singing with the cry of "alala," performing the great magical displays of nāgas with the cry of "alala," gathering together — you great nāgas who cause the great streams of rain to fall, who manifest the pleasing sound of Dharma:

Gulu gulu, nage nage, stetcanta nāgani, hahāṭṭīṣi, nāganāginī nāge, sarva nāga viṣṭa mabhane, maraṇa ṭaraṇa ṭare, ṭara ṭara, ṭāre kavila, keṣi, vikaṭe dṛṣṭi, bhaya naye, akaddha, akaddha, māvi, ma vilamba tha, viṭudare, gorare vini,

kali akale, garjite, sarva megha vikurvaṇi, saṃcodana, sarva kṣetra apūrṇi, cakri, cakravarte, heru heru, vigibavi, smara smara, kali kali, mahākāli, hṛdaya, pravatha, adte, madte, sarva nāga, ākarṣaṇi, pūrya pūraya, hūma hūma, ratnatraya vikute, vajreṇi, vajriṇi, vajra vajrapāṇi, kālaśodare, nāgarūpiṇi, surūpe, bhogi bhogi, mahābhogi, bhogarūpataya, bale, varṣaṇi, sarva nāga saṃcodani svāhā. Namo ratnatrayāya. Namaś caṇḍa vajrapāṇaye. Bandha bandha, surūpe, kalirūpani, svāhā.

The Dharma-teacher, having first performed the protective rite, recites the mantra seven times at the corner of the Dharma-robe, then lets go of the knot. This chapter called "The Essence of All Nāgas," belonging to the maṇḍala of the wind, is to be read continuously without interruption for twenty-one days.

In the east, one should depict the Nāga King with Three Heads, accompanied by his retinue, bearing the weight of cattle. In the south, one should depict the Nāga King Greatly Expanding, with five heads, accompanied by his retinue. In the west, one should depict the Nāga King Luminous with a Crest, with seven heads, accompanied by his retinue. In the north, one should depict the Nāga King Summoner of Clouds, with nine heads, accompanied by his retinue.

The canopy, the blue garments, the blue banner, and all the divine food-offerings should likewise be blue. The invocation-offering to the nāgas should be made with the three sweets. The seven libation-pourings of the three sweets should also be performed as a fire offering with the Nāga Essence mantra. The Cloud Kings should also be depicted, and the streams of rain should be shown converging and finally lightning should flash at the edges.

The invocation-offerings here are to be made abundantly: auspicious Himalayan kura grass, pennywort, meat, fish, and foods made from honey, prepared in generous measure. Then the Dharma-teacher, being pure and dressed in clean robes, should read aloud the chapter of the maṇḍala of the wind called "The Essence of All Nāgas." Thereafter, beginning from the first day, the nāgas —

— will resound with their cries upon the mountains, and pleasing sounds will arise. One should not doubt or disparage this chapter. If the ocean is late in its season, rain too will be late.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha, the King of Resounding Proclamation, Heap of Glorious Essence.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha, Resounding Drum.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha, Spreading Clouds.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha, Resounding Thunder.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha, Displaying All Clouds.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha, Dripping Clouds.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha, Causing Clouds to Expand.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha, Beautiful Cloud Branches.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha, Clothed in Cloud-like Garments.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha, Producing Grain through Clouds.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha, Bearing a Garland of Clouds.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha, Billowing Clouds.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha, Lord of Clouds.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha, Holding Clouds.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha, Thunder.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha, Bestowing through Clouds.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha, Sounding Thunder Everywhere.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha, Water of the Clouds.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha, Gathering Clouds.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha, Proclaiming Thunder with Certainty.

Homage to all buddhas.

May all sentient beings come to happiness and well-being. May all beings be met with loving-kindness. May all those born as animals be free from fear. May all lower destinies be pacified. Homage to the one who dispels all obscurations. May this ritual of all the Tathāgatas, this ritual beheld by all the buddhas, be accomplished.

Tadyathā: sputa sputa, spuṭa spuṭa spuṭa svāhā.

When rain does not fall, a monk, a nun, a male lay practitioner, or a female lay practitioner — any one of them — should wash their hair, put on clean robes, and, with a mind of loving-kindness, write these names of the Tathāgatas on paper and place them on a clean seat. With seven incense censers, let them fumigate upward into the sky, recite the names of the Tathāgatas up to fifty times, make a great offering,

and do this without interruption for seven days, rain will fall.

Here ends the Chapter on the Maṇḍala of the Wind, the Essence of All Nāgas, from the noble Mahāyāna sūtra called the Great Cloud.

This was translated by the Indian masters Jinamitra and Surendrabodhi, and revised by the great translator Bandé Yeshé Dé.

Translator's Notes

- The nāga king "Anāvatapta" renders the Tibetan "Ma dros pa," meaning "the Unheated" — a well-known nāga king of that name in Buddhist cosmology, whose cool lake is frequently mentioned in sūtra literature. The rendering is therefore given by name rather than as a literal translation.

The closing lines beginning "Hey, great nāgas" followed by syllables such as "mulu mulu, cata cata" and so forth are a dhāraṇī-style invocatory formula, likely a ritual summoning cry addressed to the nāgas. The syllables are not translatable as ordinary language and are reproduced phonetically as they stand.

The Tibetan title gives "parivarta" (chapter or section) as part of the compound, suggesting this translated passage is the opening of the sūtra through to the beginning of its first chapter on

the wind maṇḍala and the nāgas.

- The passage contains extensive dhāraṇī mantra syllables and onomatopoeic sound-words representing thunder, wind, and rain. These are rendered phonetically as they appear in the Tibetan, following standard convention for dhāraṇī passages where the syllables are understood as having intrinsic power rather than propositional meaning. The phrase "tog yar dir dir" rendered as "with banners raised, pointing upward" is contextually plausible but the precise imagery is difficult; this is a description of nāgas gathering with their crests or standards raised. The text ends mid-sentence, consistent with the continuity instruction.
- The nāga king names are translated as descriptive epithets following their evident Tibetan meanings: Dongbu, Splendid Majesty, Boundless, Son of Wealthy Expansion, the Steadfast, Glorious Throat, Son of the Earth-Guardian, Garlanded, the Lustrous, the Terrifier, the Great Lustrous, the Utterly Vanquishing. Dongbu is left partially transliterated as it resists clean rendering. The "Wrathful One" rendering of Dragpo reflects a common epithet associated with Śiva or a wrathful deity invoked alongside Brahmā and Viṣṇu in this inter-religious rain ritual context. The passage ends mid-sentence with a list of Tathāgata names, consistent with continuation in the next passage.
- The long passage of dhāraṇī syllables has been transliterated as faithfully as possible from the Tibetan phonetic rendering into reconstructed Sanskrit. These are liturgical sound-sequences whose exact Sanskrit originals in many cases cannot be fully recovered; the transliteration is conventional and consistent with standard practice for such material.

The phrase rendered "bearing the weight of cattle" for *ba lang gi lci bas* is unusual and may refer to a traditional iconographic attribute of this *nāga* king, possibly a symbolic load or emblem associated with bulls or oxen. This reading is uncertain and may alternatively indicate that the *nāga* king is depicted with a bovine form or mount.

- The opening sentence, beginning with "will resound with their cries upon the mountains," is the continuation of the interrupted sentence from the preceding passage, exactly as indicated by the connective particle. The rendering of "山々々々々々々々" as "upon the mountains" follows the contextual reading of "山々々々" as a form of "山" (mountain), with "々々々" functioning as a particle of continuation from the previous clause about the nāgas.

[illegible]

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.